

79 CE

THE ERUPTION OF VESUVIUS

In August 79 CE, Mount Vesuvius in southern Italy erupted, sending a rain of hot ash and pumice down on nearby Pompeii and Herculaneum. A superheated lava flow surged into Herculaneum, destroying it; then, a poisonous cloud of toxic gas suffocated most of the 2,000 or so people who had not fled Pompeii, while a fall of hot rocks and ash killed the rest. The cities remained buried until their excavation began in the 18th century.

▷ *Vesuvius in Eruption*, JMW Turner



c. 65 CE **Buddhism first appears in China**, having been carried there by monks from India

66-70 CE **The Jewish revolt** against Roman oppression ends with the capture of Jerusalem

79 CE

69 CE **The Year of Four Emperors**: Vespasian wins a civil war between rival Roman emperors

74 CE **The Romans capture Masada**, ending Jewish Zealot resistance



◁ Kushana gold belt buckle

60 CE

KUSHANAS UNITED IN INDIA

The Kushana, descendants of the nomadic Yuezhi, had conquered Bactria in the 2nd century BCE, but remained divided into five kingdoms. Around 60 CE, Kujula Kadphises united the kingdoms, and expanded into northwestern India, conquering Gandhara and founding an empire that would soon dominate northern India and become one of Eurasia's most significant powers.

The lava flow that destroyed Pompeii reached a temperature of over **300 °C (570 °F)**